

Evidence-led SEO Strategy

A 16-week operating strategy for technical integrity, discoverability, information architecture, and measured content growth.

CLIENT	Kakawa Chocolates
EVIDENCE AS OF	2026-07-15
RUN	KAKAWA-ENT-20260715
STATUS	APPROVAL-READY

This report distinguishes verified evidence, derived analysis, professional judgment, and unavailable data. No client website or external platform was changed.

GPT evidence-constrained strategic synthesis

Establish the evidence boundary before publishing decisions: Evidence coverage is 35.0%, below the 70% publication threshold, and the overall health score is therefore withheld. Private analytics and market baselines are unavailable because GSC, GA4, SEMrush and PageSpeed data were not collected. Implementation: Record the evidence boundary and unavailable-source register; confirm the approved .com.au domain and exclusion rules; connect and validate GSC, GA4, SEMrush and PageSpeed where credentials become available, or preserve truthful unavailable states. Do not publish performance, ranking, conversion, revenue, backlink or forecast claims.

Prioritise crawl and template hygiene: The approved findings record HTTP 404 responses on 42 of 357 fetched pages, missing primary headings on 2 of 357 pages, missing meta descriptions on 12 of 357 pages, multiple primary headings on 3 of 357 pages and long document titles on 62 of 357 pages. Implementation: Validate each error URL and its ownership; review redirects and canonicals; then resolve priority title, meta-description and H1 issues on representative templates before broader implementation. Re-crawl staging and reconcile the normalized URL inventory after changes.

Refresh existing URLs rather than creating competing pages: The approved opportunity set contains 20 content-intent clusters, each with a decision to refresh an existing target and not create a competing URL. Implementation: Freeze one accountable URL per approved intent, document duplicate-title and H1 clusters, and maintain a cannibalization ledger. Prioritise existing targets such as the homepage, gift-box, chocolate-bar, praline-and-bonbon, single-origin, corporate, wedding, wholesale, shipping, journal and seasonal collection URLs only after editorial review.

Keep redirects, canonicals, schema and releases approval-gated: The approved action sequence classifies redirect, canonical, product-template, schema and release activities as requiring agency-admin approval or other gated decisions. The limitations state that risky deployment proposals are withheld pending human Gate 1/Gate 2 and agency-admin decisions. Implementation: Use staging only for approved redirects and canonicals; validate product indexability, collection pagination and canonical targets; create a verified fact pack before proposing Product schema; deploy only approved page-specific schema candidates; re-crawl and run domain-safety, link, redirect, canonical and schema gates before any release.

Build measurement before CRO or commercial performance claims: No traffic, ranking, conversion, revenue, backlink or performance forecast is present, and analytics validation is required before CRO claims or experiment baselines can be supported. Implementation: Validate GA4 events and conversion definitions, map priority journeys only after validation, and create an experiment backlog with approved baselines and owners. Until then, treat CRO and commercial impact as unavailable rather than inferred.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

Use model synthesis for narrative prioritisation only; canonical records remain authoritative.

Evidence posture

The public acceptance run produced 5 aggregated deterministic findings. GSC, GA4, SEMrush and PageSpeed remain unavailable because credentials were not supplied.

Technical and on-page observations can support a bounded remediation programme. Forecasts, ranking claims and traffic targets cannot be published until private baselines are connected and approved.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

Approve the public evidence boundary before using the package to prioritise implementation.

Technical integrity before expansion

Resolve high-confidence crawl findings, then validate redirect, canonical and internal-link graphs in staging. Risky files remain withheld until an agency administrator approves a page-specific change.

Re-crawl after each release and reconcile the resulting URL inventory to the canonical page register rather than relying on narrative counts.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

No redirect, canonical, robots or schema proposal becomes deployable from this package alone.

One intent, one accountable target

Use existing approved-domain pages as the default targets. Create a new URL only after evidence shows a distinct intent that an existing page cannot satisfy.

This acceptance build contains 20 distinct existing-page refresh opportunities; it does not pad the roadmap to twenty assets.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

Refresh existing targets and preserve a documented cannibalisation decision for every content asset.

Measurement before prediction

Connect GSC and GA4 in staging, document conversion definitions and freeze an approved baseline. Only then may the team model sourced scenario bands.

SEMrush and PageSpeed can enrich prioritisation when available, but they do not replace first-party search and conversion evidence.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

Publish no traffic, revenue or ranking forecast from the public fixture.

Human-controlled release

Gate 1 accepts evidence and strategic direction. Gate 2 accepts the canonical action plan, content drafts and deployment proposals. Both decisions are immutable audit events.

The current package is ready for those reviews; it does not assert that either reviewer has approved it.

STRATEGIC
DECISION

Production promotion remains blocked until both gates and final QA are complete.

Canonical opportunity map

Cluster	Intent	Target URL	Decision	Evidence
Sydney artisan chocolate shopping guide	brand and product discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0001
Chocolate gift box selection guide	gift selection	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/gift-boxes	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0011
Chocolate bar collection guide	collection discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/chocolate-bar	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0006
Praline and bonbon selection guide	collection discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/pralines-bonbons	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0017
Chocolate slab buying guide	collection discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/chocolate-slab	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0008
Single-origin chocolate collection guide	product education	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/single-origin-chocolates	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0018
Design-your-own chocolate box guide	custom selection	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/design-your-own-box	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0081
Confectionery collection guide	collection discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /collections/confectionary	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0009
Corporate chocolate enquiry guide	commercial enquiry	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/corporate-chocolates	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0022
Events and corporate chocolate planning guide	event enquiry	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/events-corporates	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0023
Wedding chocolate planning guide	wedding enquiry	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/wedding-chocolates	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0033
Wholesale chocolate enquiry guide	trade enquiry	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/wholesale	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0034
Chocolate delivery planning guide	shipping support	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/shipping	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0031
About Kakawa evidence-led page refresh	brand education	https://kakawachocolates.com.au /pages/about-us	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0020

Cluster	Intent	Target URL	Decision	Evidence
How Kakawa presents its chocolate-making process	brand education	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/pages/how-we-make-chocolate	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0024
Ingredients and ethics information guide	trust and product education	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/pages/our-ingredients-and-ethics	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0026
Kakawa rewards information guide	membership support	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/pages/membership	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0025
Chocolate journal discovery hub	informational discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/blogs/chocolates	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0002
Christmas chocolate planning guide	seasonal gift discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/collections/christmas	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0193
Easter chocolate planning guide	seasonal gift discovery	https://kakawachocolates.com.au/collections/easter	Refresh existing target; do not create a competing URL	EV-0194

Measurement contract

KPI	Baseline	Cadence	Source	Decision use
Google organic clicks	Unavailable	Weekly	GSC	Prioritise page and query opportunities after connection
Organic conversions	Unavailable	Weekly	GA4	Measure commercial outcome after event validation
Non-brand visibility	Unavailable	Monthly	SEMrush	Triangulate discovery only; not a first-party replacement
Core Web Vitals	Unavailable	Release + monthly	PageSpeed	Target template-level performance work after samples exist
Critical/High QA failures	0 in review package	Every release	Studio QA	Block package release when non-zero